

The Dance School Awards: Industry Award - Dance School of the Year

Dance School of the Year Application / Nomination Questions.

Please find below 5 questions which we will need you to answer to proceed with your nomination.

Judges will consider:

- Clear, specific achievements from the past year and why they matter.
- Evidence of positive impact on students, staff, or the wider community.
- A clearly articulated ethos and set of values.
- Thoughtful support for students with different goals and pathways.
- Clear safeguarding procedures embedded in everyday practice.
- Awareness of student wellbeing and duty of care.
- Evidence of commitment to equity, diversity, and inclusion in policies, practice, and culture.
- Strong leadership and professional standards.
- A compelling overall case for why the school stands out.

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ElliTe Studios

1. Tell us 3 things you are most proud of your school achieving in the last year. *

Multiple DWC World Champions across multiple genres.

Having a successful BTEC graduation cohort all accepting places to their chosen MT/dance degree courses and children accepted into the Royal Ballet School.

Training aspiring dance teachers and having a hundred percent success rate in passing teaching exams.

2. How would you describe your school's ethos and values? *

At our welcoming and inspiring dance school in Wakefield, West Yorkshire, we believe every young person should have the opportunity to grow in confidence, creativity and self-expression through dance. We are committed to providing a supportive, inclusive environment where every student feels valued, encouraged and challenged to achieve their personal best. Whether dancing for fun, making new friends or developing technique and performance skills, we offer high-quality extra-curricular classes that nurture a lifelong love of dance for everyone.

3. How do you support both recreational and aspiring professional students? *

We are proud to support every dancer's individual journey, whether they attend simply for the joy of dancing or aspire to pursue performance and vocational training. Our classes are designed to help every student flourish at their own pace, building confidence, resilience and a love for dance in a positive and encouraging environment. For those with professional ambitions, we provide expert training and opportunities to develop the technical skills, artistry and discipline needed to reach their full potential, while ensuring that every child feels equally valued, inspired and celebrated.

4. What does safe guarding and student wellbeing look like in practice at your school? *

The wellbeing and safety of every student is at the heart of everything we do. We are committed to creating a nurturing, inclusive and respectful environment where every child feels safe, supported and able to thrive. Our experienced team promotes positive relationships, encourages kindness and celebrates individuality, ensuring that each student is valued both as a dancer and as a person. As a school registered with the Imperial Society of Teachers of Dancing (ISTD), we are committed to maintaining the highest standards of teaching, professionalism and safeguarding. Through robust safeguarding practices, high standards of care and open communication with families, we provide a positive environment where young people can grow in confidence, develop resilience and enjoy every step of their dance journey.

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5. Why do you believe your school deserves this award? *

At the heart of our dance school is a belief that dance has the power to transform lives. We are more than a place to learn steps and technique, —we are a community where every child is encouraged to believe in themselves, discover their potential and develop skills that will last a lifetime. Our ethos is built on kindness, inclusivity, respect and excellence, creating an environment where every student feels seen, supported and inspired to achieve their personal best.

We are proud to provide exceptional dance education for both recreational dancers and aspiring performers. Every student receives the same level of encouragement, care and opportunity, whether they attend for enjoyment, fitness and friendship or are working towards examinations, performances and vocational ambitions. By recognising each child's individual goals, we ensure every dancer can flourish in a way that is meaningful to them.

As an ISTD-registered dance school, we are committed to the highest standards of teaching, professionalism and safeguarding. Student wellbeing is central to everything we do, and we strive to create a safe, nurturing environment where children can grow in confidence, resilience and creativity while developing a lifelong love of dance.

Our success is measured not only by achievements on stage or in examinations, but by the positive impact we have on the lives of our students and their families. Seeing young people gain confidence, build lasting friendships, overcome challenges and leave our studio believing in themselves is our greatest accomplishment. It is this commitment to excellence, community and the holistic development of every child that makes our school a deserving recipient of Dance School of the Year.

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